

UK Output Area Classification 2021/22

Classification Typology,
Glossary of Variables,
Glossary of Terms,
Distribution Statistics,
Pen Portraits,
Update Technical Note

28/01/2025

Geographic Data Service

Authored by: Jakub Wyszomierski, Paul A
Longley, Alexander D Singleton, Christopher Gale,
Oliver O'Brien, Jen Hampton

Classification Typology

The classification comprises 8 Supergroups, 21 Groups and 52 Subgroups.

Supergroups are the highest level of the hierarchy, are denoted by a number, and provide information relative to the average values for the UK population at large. Supergroup descriptions are informative in themselves, but also frame the more detailed descriptions at the lower (Group and Subgroup) hierarchical levels.

Groups are the intermediate level of the classification, derived by partitioning Supergroups, and are denoted by the number of their parent Supergroup, followed by a letter. They include more specific description of areas of occurrence in addition to comparison with the parent Supergroup. Pen portraits seek to capture key household characteristics and neighbourhood attributes that differentiate occurrences from other Groups within the Supergroup. Consequently, most comparisons are drawn with mean aspects of the Supergroup.

Subgroups are the lowest tier of the typology and are derived from further partitioning of Groups. They are identified using the parent Group label (Supergroup number and Group letter), followed by a further number. They provide a detailed summary of the distinctiveness of the Subgroup relative to their parent Group. Their pen portraits may also draw comparisons with UK and Subgroup averages – something that may be particularly useful for depicting localised neighbourhood effects.

Data:

The classification was founded on the 2021 Census data for England and Wales that were available at the Output Area level. Control variables for Northern Ireland were included from more aggregate 2021 Census data, and for Scotland as modelled 2022 data respectively. Northern Ireland and Scotland cluster assignments were updated once Output Area data for 2021 or 2022 were made available.

Full published details of the Output Area Classification methodology can be found in the following paper: Wyszomierski, J., Longley, P. A., Singleton, A. D., Gale, C., & O’Brien, O. (2023). A neighbourhood output area classification from the 2021 and 2022 UK censuses. The Geographical Journal, 190(2), e12550. <https://doi.org/10.1111/geoj.12550>. Details of the cluster update methodology can be found in the technical note at the end of this document along with further details of how these assignments have also been used to create a lookup for LSOA, Data Zone and Super Data Zone geography.

This final updated classification covers the full extent of the UK.

Glossary of Variables

Supergroups, Groups and Subgroups were developed using the variables detailed below. For the sake of better comprehension, the pen portraits commonly abbreviate the categories, rather than using the full description. As detailed in Wyszomierski et al (2023), our best endeavours to render data comparable between the four constituent countries of the UK led to the use of the following variables:

Code	Variable name	Comments
v01	Lives in a communal establishment	A place that provides managed full-time or part-time supervision of residential accommodation. This includes: • university halls of residence and boarding schools • care homes, hospitals, hospices, and maternity units • prisons and other secure facilities • Single Living Accommodation in military bases
v02	Never married and never registered a civil partnership	
v03	Married or in a registered civil partnership	

v04	Separated or divorced	
v05	One-person household	
v06	Families with no children	
v07	Families with dependent children	A dependent child is any person aged 0 to 15 in a household or a person aged 16 to 18 in full-time education and living a family with his or her parent(s) or grandparent(s).
v08	Country of birth: Europe - United Kingdom	
v09	Country of birth: Europe - EU countries	
v10	Country of birth: Europe -s Non-EU countries	
v11	Country of birth: Africa	
v12	Usual residents per square kilometre	
v13	Aged 4 years and under	
v14	Aged 5 to 14	
v15	Aged 25 to 44	
v16	Aged 45 to 64	
v17	Aged 65 to 84	
v18	Aged 85 years and over	

v19	Address one year ago is the same as the address of enumeration	
v20	Bangladeshi ethnic group	England and Wales variable: the “Bangladeshi” tick box under the Asian, Asian British or Asian Welsh high-level group. There will not be a full count of everyone who identified as Bangladeshi as some people may have written in Bangladeshi under a different high-level ethnic group.
v21	Chinese ethnic group	England and Wales variable: the “Chinese” tick box under the Asian, Asian British or Asian Welsh high-level group. There will not be a full count of everyone who identified as Chinese as some people may have written in Chinese under a different high-level ethnic group.
v22	Indian ethnic group	England and Wales variable: the “Indian” tick box under the Asian, Asian British or Asian Welsh high-level group. There will not be a full count of everyone who identified as Indian as some people may have written in Indian under a different high-level ethnic group.
v23	Pakistani ethnic group	England and Wales variable: the “Pakistani” tick box under the Asian, Asian British or Asian Welsh high level group. There will not be a full count of everyone who identified as Pakistani as some people may have written in Pakistani under a different high-level ethnic group.
v24	Other Asian group	England and Wales variable: the “Any other Asian background” tick box under the Asian, Asian British or Asian Welsh high-level group - referring to backgrounds other than Bangladeshi, Chinese, Indian or Pakistani. In the pen portraits these variables are shortened to “Other Asian”.
v25	Black ethnic group	England and Wales variable: a tick box or write in under: Black, Black British, Black Welsh, Caribbean or African. In the pen portraits these variables are shortened to “Black”.
v26	Mixed or Multiple ethnic groups	England and Wales variable: a tick box or write in under: Mixed or Multiple ethnic groups.
v27	White ethnic group	England and Wales and Scotland variable: a tick box or write in under “White”. Tick boxes for England and Wales included: “English, Welsh, Scottish, Northern Irish, British”, “Irish”, “Gypsy or Irish Traveller”, “Roma” and “Other White”. In the pen portraits these variables are shortened to “White”.
v28	Same-ethnicity households	Defined as a proportion of all households.

v29	Main language is not English: cannot speak English well or at all	In England and Wales and Northern Ireland this combines two questions: “What is your main language?” and “How well can you speak English?”. It does not tell us about ability to speak other languages and it does not tell us what language is spoken at home.
v30	No religion	In England and Wales this uses the “No religion” tick box under the “What is your religion?” question
v31	Christian	In England and Wales this uses the “Christian” tick box under the “What is your religion?” question.
v32	Other religion	In England and Wales this includes any other tick box under the “What is your religion?” question and any write ins. Tick boxes included: Buddhist, Hindu, Jewish, Muslim and Sikh.
v33	Standardised Disability Ratio	Calculated on the basis of the number of people who are classed as disabled under the Equality Act and who have been assessed as having their day-to-day activities limited by long-term physical or mental health conditions or illness. The ratio was calculated with the disability counts at the small geography level and the disability proportions of two age groups (accounting for age being strongly correlated with disability measures) at the UK level. While the statistics on disabilities were available at the LGD level in 2021 (hence it was possible to estimate the numbers of people with disability at the SA level in 2021), the proportions for specific age bands were not available for 2021. For this reason, the 2021 UK level age-standardised disability proportions were calculated using the 2021 England and Wales proportions and 2011 Northern Ireland and Scotland proportions.
v34	Provides unpaid care	An unpaid carer who gives help or support to anyone who has long-term physical or mental ill-health condition or illness, or problems related to old age. The question asks individual to exclude anything they do as part of paid employment. The variable was derived from two different population bases: In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 5 and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents</u>.
v35	Unshared dwelling: Detached whole house or bungalow	
v36	Unshared dwelling: Semi-detached house or bungalow	
v37	Unshared dwelling: Terraced	

v38	Unshared dwelling: Flats, maisonettes or apartments	This includes: • Unshared dwelling: In a purpose-built block of flats or tenement • Unshared dwelling: Part of a converted or shared house, including bedsits • Unshared dwelling: Part of another converted building, for example, former school, church, or warehouse • Unshared dwelling: In a commercial building, for example, in an office building, hotel, or over a shop
v39	Two or more cars or vans	
V40	Under-occupancy	Measured by the percentage of households who have at least one room more than required. The number of rooms for 2021 is taken from Valuation Office Agency (VOA) administrative data and is recorded at the address level, whilst the 2011 Census recorded the number of rooms at the household level. In 2021 the question did not include bathrooms, toilets, halls or landings, kitchens, conservatories or utility rooms; while the 2011 question included kitchens, conservatories and utility rooms and excluded rooms that can be used for storage.
v41	Overcrowding	The number of rooms for 2021 is taken from Valuation Office Agency (VOA) administrative data and is recorded at the address level, whilst the 2011 Census recorded the number of rooms at the household level. In 2021 the question did not include bathrooms, toilets, halls or landings, kitchens, conservatories or utility rooms; while the 2011 question included kitchens, conservatories and utility rooms and excluded rooms that can be used for storage.
v42	Social rented	Rented through a local council or housing association.
v43	Private rented	Rented through a private landlord or letting agent.
v44	Homeownership	This includes: • Owned outright, which is where the household owns all of the accommodation. • Owned with a mortgage or loan. • Partly-owned on a shared ownership scheme.
v45	Part-time	Defined as the proportion of people who worked 30 hours or less (including paid and unpaid overtime) a week before the Census. The variable was derived for two different population bases: In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.

v46	Full-time	Defined as the proportion of people who worked more than 30 hours (including paid and unpaid overtime) a week before the Census. The variable was derived for two different population bases: In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v47	Full-time students	Derived from the National Statistics Socio-economic Classification (NS-SEC). Full-time students are recorded in the “full-time students” category regardless of whether or not they are economically active. The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v48	1. Managers, directors, and senior officials	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v49	2. Professional occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases: In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v50	3. Associate professional and technical occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases: In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v51	4. Administrative and secretarial occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v52	5. Skilled trades occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v53	6. Caring, leisure, and other service occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.

v54	7. Sales and customer service occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u> . In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u> .
v55	8. Process, plant, and machine operatives	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u> . In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u> .
v56	9. Elementary occupations	The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u> . In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u> .
v57	Economically active: Unemployed	Calculated as the proportion of people aged 16 years and over that are economically active but unemployed (looking for work, could start within two weeks or waiting to start a job that had been offered and accepted) a week prior to the Census. This category also includes full-time students who are economically active. The variable was derived for two different population bases. In 2021 (England and Wales) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 years and over</u>. In 2011 (Scotland and Northern Ireland) the population base consisted of <u>all usual residents aged 16 to 74</u>.
v58	Level 1, 2 or Apprenticeship	Level 1 qualifications: • 1 to 4 GCSEs grade A* to C • Any GCSEs at other grades • O levels or CSEs (any grades) • 1 AS level Level 2 qualifications: • 5 or more GCSEs (A* to C or 9 to 4) • O levels (passes) • CSEs (grade 1) • 1 A level • 2 to 3 AS levels
v59	Level 3 qualifications	Level 3 qualifications include: • 2 or more A levels or VCEs • 4 or more AS levels • Higher School Certificate • Progression or Advanced Diploma • Welsh Baccalaureate Advance Diploma
v60	Level 4 qualifications or above	Level 4 qualifications or above include: • degree (BA, BSc) • higher degree (MA, PhD, PGCE) • professional qualifications (for example, teaching, nursing, accountancy)

Glossary of Terms

1. Descriptions of ethnicity relate to census ethnic group classifications used by individual England/Wales as below:

Ethnic Group Labels relevant to Output Areas in England and Wales (from Census 2021)

Label	Relevant High Level Ethnic Group (5 broad categories)	Census Form tick boxes and write ins associated with the High Level Ethnic Groups
White	White	English, Welsh, Scottish, Northern Irish, British, Irish, Gypsy or Irish Traveller, and Roma tick boxes, and any other White background write in
Bangladeshi	Asian, Asian British, Asian Welsh	Bangladeshi tick box
Chinese	Asian, Asian British, Asian Welsh	Chinese tick box
Indian	Asian, Asian British, Asian Welsh	Indian tick box
Pakistani	Asian, Asian British, Asian Welsh	Pakistani tick box
Other Asian	Asian, Asian British, Asian Welsh	Any other Asian background write in
Black	Black, Black British, Black Welsh, Caribbean or African	African background and Caribbean tick boxes, and any other Black, Black British and Caribbean backgrounds write ins
Mixed or Multiple	Mixed or Multiple	White and Asian, White and Black African, and White and Black Caribbean tick boxes, and any other Mixed or Multiple ethnic group background write ins

2. 'Normal retirement age' is used to approximate the age at which individuals are normally able to draw state pensions. This was age 66 on Census night, but is approximated using the 65 and over aggregation from small area Census statistics.
3. 'Residential density' refers to the number of people or households within an Output Area.
4. 'Residential turnover' refers to the proportion of residents that changed address in the year preceding the Census.
5. References to 'EU born' excludes residents born in the UK, reflecting that the UK left the European Union on 31 January 2020.
6. 'Ethnic minorities' is used to describe the proportion of the population who selected an ethnic group tick-box other than a tick-box under the White high-level group on the England and Wales census form.
7. 'Ethnic diversity' is the relative prevalence of multiple ethnic minorities in an area. Some Census groups (specifically 'White Other' and 'Asian Other') that may contribute to this phenomenon are pre-aggregated in the Census data and may themselves subsume additional diversity.

Distribution Statistics

The following table shows OAC Subgroup counts and percentages of total assigned residential population and Output Areas in England and Wales. The right hand column shows the counts of local authority districts (LADs) in England and Wales in which the Subgroup is present.

Super-group	Group		Subgroup		Output Areas		Population		Count of LADs where present
					Count	%	Count	%	
1 Retired Professionals	1a	Spacious Rural Living	1a1	Pre-Retirement Spacious Living	10,758	4.5	3,038,616	4.5	303
			1a2	Retirement Spacious Living	5,109	2.1	1,129,499	1.7	286
	1b	Small Town Suburbia	1b1	Established Suburban Communities	8,546	3.6	2,555,575	3.8	317
			1b2	Older Established Suburban Communities	5,890	2.5	1,326,975	2.0	284
	1c	Established Mature Families	1c1	Affluent Mature Families	6,839	2.9	1,884,160	2.8	316
			1c2	Burgeoning Mature Families	4,990	2.1	1,347,191	2.0	296
2 Suburbanites and Peri-Urbanites	2a	Inner Suburbs and Small Town Living	2a1	Younger Suburban Family Renters	4,775	2.0	1,503,643	2.2	320
			2a2	Settled Owner-Occupied Suburbs	5,856	2.4	1,652,301	2.5	312
			2a3	Terraced Communities	4,242	1.8	1,126,449	1.7	295
	2b	Rural Amenity	2b1	Ageing Rural Communities	10,278	4.3	2,841,816	4.2	300
			2b2	Rural Mix	8,234	3.4	2,714,707	4.1	319
	2c	Ageing Communities	2c1	Communal Retirement Living	3,274	1.4	1,006,868	1.5	314
			2c2	Ageing Independent Living	12,860	5.4	3,235,558	4.8	328
3 Multicultural and Educated Urbanites	3a	Student Living and Professional Footholds	3a1	University Centric	1,012	0.4	529,553	0.8	95
			3a2	Professional Progression	1,400	0.6	252,418	0.4	78
			3a3	Urbanite Mix	2,225	0.9	314,980	0.5	160
			3a4	Affluent Graduate Living	1,610	0.7	203,426	0.3	86
	3b	Ethnically Diverse Young Families	3b1	Private Rental Ethnic Minority Families	4,001	1.7	1,172,195	1.8	191
			3b2	Young Ethnic Minority Families	2,889	1.2	795,465	1.2	131
	3c	Diverse Educated Urban Singles	3c1	Centrally Located Professionals	2,355	1.0	595,898	0.9	111
			3c2	Career Progression	5,358	2.2	1,511,105	2.3	193
4 Low-Skilled Migrant and Student Communities	4a	Ethnically Diverse Families in Less Connected Locations	4a1	Semi-Detached, Service Workers and Students	2,997	1.3	1,003,466	1.5	145
			4a2	City Service Workers	3,334	1.4	1,192,402	1.8	127
			4a3	Young Families	2,218	0.9	796,537	1.2	102
	4b	Established Multi-Ethnic Communities	4b1	Migrant Families	1,851	0.8	734,107	1.1	70
			4b2	European Skilled Workforce	2,916	1.2	1,040,229	1.6	157
			4b3	Inner Suburb Ethnic Group Mix	1,837	0.8	667,359	1.0	121
			4b4	Ethnic Minority Routine Service Workers	2,238	0.9	777,715	1.2	142
	4c		4c1	Asian Influences	2,401	1.0	1,019,290	1.5	58

		Challenged Multicultural Communities and Students	4c2	European and Asian Heritage	2,528	1.1	1,038,225	1.6	77
5 Diverse Suburb-an Professionals	5a	Outer Suburbs	5a1	Outer Suburb Asian Mix	2,940	1.2	917,468	1.4	246
			5a2	Suburban Empty Nesters	3,299	1.4	1,013,923	1.5	244
			5a3	Young Suburban Families	3,940	1.6	1,282,425	1.9	269
	5b	Suburban Professionals	5b1	Families in Multi-Ethnic Terraces	6,313	2.6	2,114,220	3.2	300
			5b2	Established Multi-Ethnic Suburbs	5,371	2.2	1,788,472	2.7	230
6 Baseline UK	6a	Challenged Communities	6a1	Suburban Housing Starters	3,524	1.5	1,178,307	1.8	249
			6a2	Semi Detached Strivers	4,936	2.1	1,554,101	2.3	280
			6a3	Younger Ethnic Minority Families in Flats	6,168	2.6	1,767,766	2.6	290
	6b	Legacy Industrial and Coastal Communities	6b1	Retired Seniors	4,870	2.0	1,371,280	2.0	325
			6b2	Traditional Terraces	3,327	1.4	914,945	1.4	284
			6b3	EU Singles	3,389	1.4	930,480	1.4	294
	6c	Multicultural Inner Suburbs	6c1	Transient Communities	3,566	1.5	1,029,545	1.5	197
			6c2	Semi-Detached Family Renters	5,589	2.3	1,778,528	2.7	278
7 Semi- and Un-Skilled Workforce	7a	Established but Challenged	7a1	Ageing Established Urban Communities	4,208	1.8	585,150	0.9	144
			7a2	Industry Associations	13,480	5.6	3,628,458	5.4	311
	7b	Young Families in Industrial Towns	7b1	Terraces in Transitional Towns	8,096	3.4	2,451,399	3.7	314
			7b2	Families and Later Life	5,896	2.5	1,389,642	2.1	279
8 Legacy Communities	8a	Routine Occupations or Retirement	8a1	Retirement Residences	920	0.4	98,581	0.1	159
			8a2	Flats and Routine Occupations	2,760	1.2	345,361	0.5	212
	8b	Legacy and Demographicall y Mixed Communities	8b1	Challenged Families	5,369	2.2	821,123	1.2	257
			8b2	Retirement Pockets	4,143	1.7	666,256	1.0	314
			8b3	Young Family Flat Renters	2,098	0.9	279,734	0.4	169

Pen Portraits

In what follows patterns described are relative to the UK average.

1: Retired Professionals

Typically married but no longer with resident dependent children, these well-educated households either remain working in their managerial, professional, administrative or other skilled occupations, or are retired from them – the modal individual age is beyond normal retirement age. Detached and semi-detached properties predominate, and unpaid care is more prevalent than reported disability. The prevalence of this Supergroup outside most urban conurbations indicates that rural lifestyles prevail, typically sustained by using two or more cars per household.

1a: Spacious Rural Living

These predominantly ageing households typically have no resident dependent children. Most are owner-occupiers and live in detached houses in low density residential developments (although renting is more common than in the rest of the Supergroup). Residents are typically beyond retirement age but those still in work have managerial or skilled trade occupations. White ethnicity and Christian religious affiliation predominate. Neighbourhoods are located throughout rural Britain.

1a1: Pre-Retirement Spacious Living

The Subgroup predominantly comprises elderly and middle aged (aged 45 or over) people, there are slightly below average UK proportions of children aged between 5 and 14, indicating that some families with children tend to have older parents. Residential densities are much lower than the UK and Group average, and include many remote rural areas. Remoteness frequently requires households to maintain two or more cars.

1a2: Retirement Spacious Living

The Subgroup is differentiated by its higher proportion of residents aged 65 years and above than elsewhere in this Group, and its lower proportions of families with dependent children and higher rates of residence in communal establishments. Provision of unpaid care and recorded disability rates are above the Group averages, indicative of high rates of advanced retirement. Many of the areas in which this Subgroup occurs have low residential densities, and are widely distributed across the UK.

1b: Small Town Suburbia

This Group is predominantly comprised of married couples with no resident dependent children, living in areas in or adjacent to small towns. White ethnic groups and affiliation with Christianity predominates. Housing tends to be predominantly semi-detached or detached and workers are employed principally in administrative and secretarial occupations, with skilled occupations also in evidence. These areas of the Supergroup are of higher population density.

1b1: Established Suburban Communities

The age distribution within this Subgroup is relatively uniform, apart from moderately lower frequencies in the 65 to 84 age range relative to the group, and fewer over 85. This age distribution results in a slightly lower disability ratio compared to both the UK and Group averages. Geographically, the Subgroup is dispersed throughout the UK, with a particular concentration across all of the Midlands.

1b2: Older Established Suburban Communities

This Subgroup is dominated by residents of normal retirement age or over, who are also more likely than the average in the Group to have been married and born in the UK. The Subgroup is predominantly White. Whilst overall levels of qualifications are around the UK average, there are slightly higher proportions of individuals qualified to level 1, level 2 or Apprenticeship. The Subgroup age structure results in slightly higher levels of unpaid care than is found elsewhere in this Group.

1c: Established Mature Families

Married couples predominate, many with older dependent children. Detached housing is common. Homeownership rates are the highest within this Supergroup. Many residents have degree level qualifications, and the occupational profile is heavily skewed towards managerial and professional occupations. Residential developments commonly occur on the periphery of major urban cities or conurbations.

1c1: Affluent Mature Families

Members of this Subgroup are significantly older than the rest of the Group, with many residents aged 65 or over and the proportion of young children is below the UK average. Although levels of disability are slightly lower than the UK average, rates of provision of unpaid care are higher than the Group average. Many residents are educated to degree level and the prevalence of senior managerial roles indicates that financial circumstances generally compare

favourably with the rest of the Group. Members of this Subgroup are more likely to reside outside of London.

1c2: Burgeoning Mature Families

This Subgroup is characterised by high proportions of families with children in the 5 to 14 age band, and parents and other residents aged 45 to 64. Incidence of the oldest retirees is below the national average. Whilst residents hold a variety of occupations and managerial positions prevail, workers are often working administrative and support functions.

2: Suburbanites and Peri-Urbanites

Pervasive throughout the UK, members of this Supergroup typically own (or are buying) their detached, semi-detached or terraced homes. They are also typically educated to A Level/Highers or degree level and work in skilled or professional or management occupations. Typically born in the UK, some families have children, although the median adult age is above 45. This Supergroup is pervasive not only in suburban locations, but also in neighbourhoods at or beyond the edge of cities that adjoin rural parts of the country.

2a: Inner Suburbs and Small Town Living

Families with resident dependent children (but not students) are common relative to the Supergroup average. Established family groups and White ethnicity predominate, as do individuals born in the UK. They are more likely than the Supergroup average to have been resident in their terraced, semi-detached for more than one year. Levels of multiple car ownership are high. Properties are owned and associate professionals and administrative occupations are prevalent, and parents are more likely to be in middle age or approaching retirement. Educational attainment is above the Supergroup average. Scattered developments and concentrations are found in many small towns.

2a1: Younger Suburban Family Renters

This Subgroup is characterised by a higher proportion of families with dependent children (especially aged 0 to 4) than the Group averages. Young adults predominate, especially over retirees. Some households rent, but mostly within the private sector, and are well qualified to A-Level/Highers or degree level, and work in professional, technical and administrative occupations.

2a2: Settled Owner-Occupied Suburbs

Adults of this Subgroup are typically more likely than elsewhere in the Group to be married, born in the UK, identify with Christian religion and speak English at home. Residents tend to be slightly older than the Group average, with those aged 65 to 84 particularly in evidence.

Housing is predominantly detached, semi detached or bungalows. Members of this Subgroup are marginally more likely than members of other Supergroups and Groups to provide unpaid social care.

2a3: Terraced Communities

Members of this Subgroup have a greater likelihood of living in terraced houses. Population density is highest in this Group and Supergroup. The incidence of ownership of two or more cars is lower than for the Group and Supergroup. Members of the Subgroup are more likely to be employed in administrative or skilled trades.

2b: Rural Amenity

This Group comprises older parents or retirees, with no resident dependent children, and with the lowest residential densities in this Supergroup. Predominantly UK-born, residents typically live in detached houses, although others do live in semi-detached properties. The level of multiple car ownership is the highest in this Supergroup. Most houses are owner occupied although social renting is also present. Many concentrations occur in high amenity rural locations, such as Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty.

2b1: Ageing Rural Communities

In these neighbourhoods, the proportions of older people, are substantially higher than the Group average, with those aged 65 to 84 being in the most common age group. There is a correspondingly low share of child and young adult residents, indicative of ageing communities. Religious affiliation is predominantly Christian, and residents are of predominantly White ethnicity. Unemployment is rare, with most of the employed working as senior managers or skilled traders.

2b2: Rural Mix

Members of this Subgroup are more demographically diverse than the Group as a whole. There are high proportions of families with dependent children of all ages (0 to 14). Full-time students are scarce. Although nationally low, there are more residents that are of Mixed or Multiple ethnic groups than the Group average. Religious affiliation is predominantly Christian, but no religious affiliations are more common than elsewhere in the Group. For the most part, this Subgroup resides owned semi-detached houses, and work as Managers directors and senior officials.

2c: Ageing Communities

Many residents are of normal retirement age or above and live in communal establishments, and there are few dependent children. The dominant property type is a mix of retirement flats and detached houses. Those in work are likely to be employed in managerial and professional occupations, and many residents are educated to degree level. Levels of owner occupation are high, but the private rental sector is also present. Rural locations predominate.

2c1: Communal Retirement Living

The age structure of this Subgroup is heavily skewed towards those well beyond the normal retirement age (particularly those aged 85 years or over), with low proportions of all other age groups. An exceptionally high rate of residence in communal establishments suggests that many reside in care homes. The incidence of disability is higher than for the Group, and detached houses or bungalows are also common. Managers and directors are amongst the most common occupations of those in the workforce.

2c2: Ageing Independent Living

Neighbourhood residents more likely to be below retirement age than the Group average. The proportion of residents living within flats is the highest in the Group. Residency in communal establishments is not common. Of the two Subgroups within the Ageing Communities Group, the Ageing Independent Living Subgroup has the lowest ethnic diversity. The occupation structure mirrors the Group pattern of high proportions of managers and professionals, and there is low incidence of elementary occupations.

3: Multicultural and Educated Urbanites

Established populations comprising ethnic minorities together with persons born outside the UK predominate in this Supergroup. Residents present diverse personal characteristics and circumstances: while generally well-educated and practising skilled occupations, there is low levels of home ownership. English may not be the main language used by people in this Group. Although the typical adult resident is middle aged, single person households are common and marriage rates are low by national standards. This Supergroup predominates in Inner London, with smaller enclaves in many other densely populated metropolitan areas.

3a: Student Living and Professional Footholds

The Group includes many students, some of whom reside in communal residences. Single-person households are the most prevalent and the modal age band is 25 to 44. There are few families with dependent children. A significant number of residents were born in EU countries (although UK-born residents are more common than in the rest of the Group), and households reflect a diversity of ethnic groups. Residential turnover is high and, communal properties aside,

flats are the norm rented from the private sector. Many residents are professionals and technicians educated to degree level, and the Group is particularly common near the campuses of established university towns and cities.

3a1: University Centric

Members of this Subgroup are exceptionally likely to live in communal establishments such as halls of residence. Typically, students and educated to at least A Level/Highers level. They are unlikely to have been married and are very unlikely to be homeowners. Non-communal living typically means residence in flats or sometimes terraced houses. Part-time working is particularly common, mostly in sales, customer service and elementary occupations. Individuals identifying as Chinese are more numerous than any other ethnic minority.

3a2: Professional Progression

Relative to the Group, this Subgroup is more likely to be aged 25 to 44. They are unlikely to be married (or divorced), and even pre-childbearing families are uncommon relative to the Group average. High numbers of individuals identifying as Chinese or Indian occur in this Subgroup. Average Standardised Disability Ratios are low as are rates of provision of unpaid care. Households are likely to be private renters and not to own multiple cars. The Subgroup is highly qualified to degree level and many residents work as managers, directors or senior officials.

3a3: Urbanite Mix

This Subgroup is characterised by diversity of household circumstances: English is often not the main language spoken; single person households are common; and unemployment rates are high relative to the Group, albeit that some of those in employment work as managers, directors and senior officials.

3a4: Affluent Graduate Living

Members of this Subgroup are unlikely to be married or with children. Adults are more likely to be in the 25 to 44 age group, and older residents are also more prevalent than elsewhere in this Group. The Subgroup is less ethnically diverse than the Group average, with slightly more White ethnic group members. Residence in the social rented sector is very rare.. Students are relatively less common, although individuals are highly skilled and educated to degree standard. Unemployment or part-time work is rare, and many individuals are employed in associate professional, technical, administrative or secretarial occupations.

3b: Ethnically Diverse Young Families

This Group includes many younger parents born overseas (particularly in Africa or non EU countries) with children aged 0-4. Individuals identifying as of Mixed or Multiple ethnicities are also common. English may not be the primary language spoken. Accommodation consists principally of flats, and many properties are socially rented. Students are also present, unemployment is common, and other adults tend to work in low skilled jobs.

3b1: Private Rental Ethnic Minority Families

This Subgroup has high rates of European-born residents, who are typically aged 25-44. The Subgroup also exhibits considerable ethnic diversity, with the highest Group share of individuals identifying as Indian or Black ethnicity. Social renting is less prevalent relative to the Group average. As throughout the Group, flats are prevalent, although less so than in other Subgroups. Unemployment is also slightly lower than the Group average, but nevertheless high relative to the UK average. Those in employment tend to hold managerial and professional positions.

3b2: Young Ethnic Minority Families

This Subgroup includes many young adults who are also very likely to have dependent children. Older generations are more prevalent than elsewhere in the Group. Many individuals identify with a Bangladeshi ethnicity, and neighbourhoods are characterised by a high level of Black ethnic group representation. Affiliation to Christian religions is low, and levels of non-English languages as the main language are the highest in the Supergroup. Members of this Subgroup are predominantly social renters, typically living in overcrowded flats. Part-time employment is also common, but rarely in managerial or professional occupations.

3c: Diverse Educated Urban Singles

This Group includes many never-married individuals not living with dependent children. Many were born in EU countries and are now aged between 25-44. This Group is characterised by its ethnic group diversity, although those identifying as Pakistani are not well represented. Reported disability rates are low. Neighbourhoods include some central locations in London and other major cities. Private renting is the norm, and many individuals are educated to degree level, and full-time employment is common, particularly in managerial and professional occupations.

3c1: – Centrally Located Professionals

Living in central urban locations, many individuals in this Subgroup fall into the 25 to 44-year age bracket. Residents are typically educated to degree level. Individuals identifying as of Indian or Chinese ethnic groups are all in evidence. Privately rented flats are the norm, and

multiple car ownership is low. Standardised Disability Ratios and provision of unpaid care are both low. Part-time work and employment in non-managerial positions are rare.

3c2: Career Progression

A significant portion of adults hold a degree and employment is predominantly concentrated in professional occupations. Individuals in this Subgroup are slightly more likely to be UK-born, compared with the Group average. The population displays a fairly balanced age distribution, with some ethnic diversity, and the housing landscape primarily consists of privately rented flats. It is uncommon for residents to own multiple vehicles.

4: Low-Skilled Migrant and Student Communities

Young adults, many of whom are students, predominate in these high-density neighbourhoods of rented terrace houses or flats. Most ethnic minorities are present in these communities, as are people born outside of the UK. Students aside, low skilled occupations predominate, and unemployment rates are above average. The Mixed or Multiple ethnic group composition of neighbourhoods is often associated with low rates of affiliation to Christian religions. This Supergroup predominates in non-central urban locations across Britain, particularly in the Midlands and the outskirts of west, south and north-east London.

4a: Ethnically Diverse Families in Less Connected Locations

This Group is often found in less central parts of London and other major towns and cities. Adults are more likely than the Supergroup average to have never been married and are typically aged less than 45 years. Many have young dependent children and individuals may have been born in Africa. There are many members identifying with a Black ethnic group, with the other ethnic groups (as listed in the glossary) also represented, though Chinese less so. Accommodation in flats, frequently socially rented, is common in these neighbourhoods. Part time employment is also common, and work is often in elementary occupations, while unemployment is also the highest within this Supergroup.

4a1: Semi-Detached, Service Workers and Students

These neighbourhoods house many families with dependent children, and children are more prevalent than elsewhere in this Group. Residents born in mainland Europe are not present in large numbers, and the ethnic group diversity of this Subgroup is lower than for the rest of the Group. Residents are typically accommodated in socially rented housing, and relative to the

Group, semi-detached properties are common. Few residents are educated to degree level or work in managerial or professional occupations.

4a2: City Service Workers

Residents born outside the UK are more common than elsewhere in this Group. While the ethnic group composition of neighbourhoods is diverse, persons identifying with a Pakistani ethnicity are much lower than the Group average. Although private renting is not the most common housing tenure, it is more prevalent here than elsewhere in the Group. Residents in this Subgroup are on average educated to higher levels than other Subgroups. Managerial and professional occupations are uncommon, with occurrences of other skilled occupations around the UK average.

4a3: Young Families

Many of the families in this Subgroup have dependent children. Ethnic group diversity is higher than the Group average, and English is frequently not a person's main language. Most families live in socially rented flats. Students are also present, as are part-time workers.

4b: Established Multi- Ethnic Communities

Parents and young children in this Group are drawn from diverse ethnic backgrounds. Employment is typically as process plant and machine operatives or elementary occupations. The residential landscape is dominated by terraced housing, although semi-detached houses and flats are also present. This Group is found in London and in many provincial towns and cities throughout the U.K.

4b1: Migrant Families

These neighbourhoods are characterised by the highest Group proportions of people born outside the UK. Limited English language skills are common in this Group. Identification with an Indian ethnicity is common. Many residents are married have dependent children.

4b2: European Skilled Workforce

Members of this Subgroup have a higher probability than other Subgroups of being born in the EU, and of holding degree level qualifications. Neighbourhood populations are relatively young, with low proportions above normal retirement age, and have the low levels of long-term disability.

4b3: Inner Suburb Ethnic Group Mix

These neighbourhoods occur in the inner suburbs of many provincial towns and cities. They have more children aged 5 to 14 but fewer adults aged 25 to 44 than is the case elsewhere in this Group. UK born individuals are more common in this Subgroup. Few residents live in flats and private renting is less common than elsewhere in the Group. More household residents speak English very well or well than elsewhere in the Group. Provision of unpaid care is higher than the Group average. Employment structure is not concentrated in any particular sector.

4b4 - Ethnic Minority Routine Service Workers

Residents are more likely to be UK-born than elsewhere in the Group. Ethnic minorities identifying as Pakistani are more prevalent than the Group average. Residents tend to be slightly older than the Group average, and adults of normal retirement age or older are particularly in evidence. The Subgroup has levels of English language proficiency above the Group average (but below the UK average). Terraced housing is less common than elsewhere in the Group, and social housing remains the most common form of housing. The overall employment structure is diverse, but is concentrated in caring, leisure and other service occupations.

4c: Challenged Multicultural Communities and Students

Married couples with dependent children are common in this Group, with many parents born in the EU. The representation of residents amongst different ethnic minority groups is high, particularly for individuals of Pakistani, Indian and Bangladeshi ethnic groups. For many residents, English is not their main language, and affiliation to Christian religions is less common. Privately rented terrace properties predominate. Part time work is common, with many employed in elementary occupations, as process plant and machine operatives or in sales and customer services. There are also many students living within these areas, and overall unemployment levels are high.

4c1: Asian Influences

The Subgroup includes many individuals identifying with the Indian ethnic group than elsewhere in the Group, with more also born in EU countries. There are fewer families with dependent children than elsewhere in the Group, although rates are high than the UK average. Rates of Christian religious affiliation are low. Members of this Subgroup are slightly more likely to be private renters. The occupation structure is very similar to the Group average, though degree levels of educational qualification are slightly higher, although under the UK average.

4c2: European and Asian Heritage

Although many residents of this Subgroup are born in EU countries, UK-born members are also marginally more common than elsewhere in the Group. Many residents identify with the Pakistani ethnic group. Residents are more likely than members of other Subgroup to reside in properties that are not flats. The members of the Subgroup are educated to lower levels than the Group average, with marginally more employed as process plant and machine operatives

5: Diverse Suburban Professionals

Those working within the managerial, professional and administrative occupations typically reflect a wide range of ethnic groups, and reside in detached or semi-detached housing. Their residential locations at the edges of cities and conurbations and car-based lifestyles are more characteristic of Supergroup membership than birthplace or participation in child-rearing. Houses are typically owner-occupied and marriage rates are higher than the national average. This Supergroup is found throughout suburban Britain.

5a: Outer Suburbs

These neighbourhoods are found on the outer edges of many towns and cities. Many residents were born outside the UK. Chinese and Indian ethnic group representations are high. There are high numbers of families with dependent children aged 5 to 14. Incidences of disability and of provision of unpaid care are low. Neighbourhoods provide a mix of detached and semi detached housing with flats and terraced housing uncommon. Homeownership rates are high. Professional and managerial occupations are prevalent: unemployment is low and education to degree level is the norm.

5a1 – Outer Suburb Asian Mix

Residents identify with diverse, but principally Asian ethnic groups, and affiliation with Christian religions is below the Group average. Accommodation is more often in privately rented flats than the Group average, but below national rates. Similar to the overall Group profile, residents are more likely to be employed as managers, directors or senior officials, but are typically educated only to intermediate levels.

5a2: Suburban Empty Nesters

Marriage, Christian religious affiliation and UK birthplaces are each more common than elsewhere in the Group. Residents also tend to be aged 45 years or above, and numbers of residents with dependent children are not high - indicating that they may have left home when becoming young adults. The proportion of residents living in communal establishments such as care homes is the highest in the Group. Ethnic diversity is substantially lower than elsewhere

in the Group, with those identifying as of Black ethnicities being notably absent. The dominant housing type is detached houses, and the share of flats is below the Group average. More workers are employed as managers, directors and senior officials.

5a3: Young Suburban Families

Subgroup members tend to be younger than the rest of the Group. Correspondingly fewer residents live in communal establishments, and families with dependent children are more common. Residents who identify as belonging to Mixed or Multiple ethnicities are more prevalent. Incidences of disability and provision of unpaid care are below average. Members of the Subgroup are much more likely to reside in terraced houses and are less likely to work part-time.

5b: Suburban Professionals

Employment in this Group is typically in managerial and professional occupations, and education to degree level is common. Residents are typically of working age, many of whom identify with an Indian ethnicity. Relative to the Supergroup, households are unlikely to be of Mixed or Multiple ethnicities, and English is not the main language used in some households. This Group is found on the outskirts of most conurbations as well as in the suburbs of some free-standing towns.

5b1: Families in Multi-Ethnic Terraces

Cohabiting couples with young families are common in these neighbourhoods. There are few individuals beyond retirement age and few students. These neighbourhoods have a multi-ethnic character. Individuals tend to take a more secular view of religion than the rest of the Group. Terraces are prevalent relative to the Group average, alongside some detached and semi-detached houses or bungalows.

5b2: Established Multi-Ethnic Suburbs

Many adults are married or in civil partnerships, and the population is older than the Group mean, with more adults beyond retirement age. Individuals identifying as Indian or Pakistani ethnic groups are much in evidence. No religious affiliation is also uncommon. Flats and terraced houses are rare, and homeownership is the common tenure. Education levels are above the Group mean and employment is concentrated in managerial and professional occupations.

6: Baseline UK

This Supergroup exemplifies the broad base to the UK's social structure, encompassing as it does the average or modal levels of many neighbourhood characteristics, including all housing tenures, a range of levels of educational attainment and religious affiliations, and a variety of pre-retirement age structures. Yet, in combination, these mixes are each distinctive of the parts of the UK. Overall, terraced houses are the most prevalent, as is employment in intermediate or low-skilled occupations. However, this Supergroup is also characterised by above average levels of unemployment and lower levels of use of English as the main language. Many neighbourhoods occur in south London and the UK's other major urban centres.

6a: Challenged Communities

Residents of these neighbourhoods typically live in households with dependent children, and there are fewer-than-average residents of normal retirement age or over. Identification with ethnic minorities, particularly Black, or Mixed or Multiple ethnicities is common. Housing predominantly consists of semi-detached houses, along with a significant number of terraced properties and fewer flats. Social housing is also quite common, and private renting occurs below average UK levels. Those in employment work mainly in caring leisure and other services; process, plant and machine operation; or elementary occupations. Unemployment is high, and few individuals have degree level qualifications. Many of these neighbourhoods occur in commuter towns or less accessible areas of larger towns and cities.

6a1: Suburban Housing Starters

The Subgroup comprises younger adults, only rarely living alone. Neighbourhoods are ethnically diverse, with many individuals identifying with the Black ethnic group. Housing is principally semi-detached or terraced. While residence in the social rented sector is common, this is slightly less so than in the Group as a whole.

6a2: Semi Detached Strivers

These typically nUK born, married couples tend to be older and comprise a slightly lower ethnically diverse mix than the Group. Housing is predominantly semi-detached, with much lower incidence of terraces than elsewhere in the Group. Homeownership is slightly more common within this Subgroup. Households are likely to own multiple cars and to work in managerial or professional occupations.

6a3 – Younger Ethnic Minority Families in Flats

Neighbourhood residents are relatively young, and the Subgroup is characterised by lower-than-Group-average rates of marriage and childless families. Ethnic diversity is moderate,

though with higher representation of Black or Mixed or Multiple background ethnicities. Residents are more likely to live socially rented flats or terraces and are less likely to speak English very well or well. Households with multiple cars are uncommon. Attainment of higher-level qualifications is below the Group average, and employment is skewed towards elementary occupations.

6b: Legacy Industrial and Coastal Communities

Single-person households are common in these neighbourhoods, and these residents are typically divorced rather than never married. A high proportion of residents were born in the EU. There are more young adults, some with young children, but relatively few residents are of normal retirement age or over. The predominant housing types are terraced houses, which are typically part of the private rented sector. This Group is commonly found in coastal areas and (present-day or former) industrial towns and cities.

6b1: Retired Seniors

These neighbourhoods are characterised by high proportions of elderly people, with higher numbers than the Group average living in communal establishments. Incidence of individuals born in the EU are lower than the Group average. Ethnic diversity is low, although Group levels of identification with Mixed or Multiple ethnicities are around the Group average. The housing stock is mixed but terraced accommodation is the most common. Relative to the Group, Managerial, professional and technical occupations provide the main employment for those in employment, and there are few students.

6b2: Traditional Terraces

Young, single or childless couples born in the UK are common. Neighbourhoods are typically densely populated with low ethnic diversity, although some individuals identify with Pakistani or Bangladeshi ethnicities relative to the Group averages. Households typically live in terraced houses that are privately rented or owner occupied. Those in employment work principally in intermediate professions, including secretarial and service occupations.

6b3: EU Singles

Residents in this Subgroup are typically single or divorced EU-born migrants who live alone. Many are aged 25 to 44 and are employed in sales and customer service occupations or are process, plant and machine operatives. A higher than Group average proportion identify with the White ethnic group or Other Asian ethnicities, and many do not speak English very well or well. Housing is principally in flats or terraces in the private rented sector, with home ownership rare.

6c: Multicultural Inner Suburbs

These neighbourhoods house many younger and middle-aged adults with children. All ethnic minorities, apart from those identifying as Pakistani or Bangladeshi, appear to be present in above average proportions. Long-term disability rates are low, mirrored in limited provision of unpaid care. Privately rented terrace houses and flats are the norm. Managerial, professional and technical occupations are prevalent. Many individuals have degree level qualifications. These areas form the inner suburbs of many of the UK's towns and cities.

6c1 Transient Communities

These are high-density neighbourhoods with young adults, more typically born outside of the UK and unmarried. There are few children and quite a low proportion of older generation adults. Ethnic diversity is below the Group average and those identifying as White predominate, some individuals identify as Chinese. Individuals tend to eschew either no or other religious affiliations and incidence of disabilities is low. Housing is primarily in privately rented terraced houses. The Subgroup is dominated by full-time students, and graduates employed in professional and managerial occupations.

6c2 – Semi-Detached Family Renters

Contrary to the rest of the Group, and although lower than the UK average, these neighbourhoods commonly have more detached or semi-detached houses, let through the social rented sector. Adult members of this Subgroup tend to be younger than the Group average, but are more likely to be married, sometimes living with dependent children. Residents are slightly more likely to be divorced. The neighbourhoods appear to be more ethnically diverse, particularly regarding those identifying with Black ethnicities. Students and university graduates are slightly less common than the Group average, while those with GCSE and apprenticeship qualifications are more common. Employment is often as machine operatives, skilled traders than the Group average.

7: Semi- and Un-Skilled Workforce

Living in terraced or semi-detached houses, residents of these neighbourhoods typically lack high levels of education and work in elementary or routine service occupations. Unemployment is above average. Residents are predominantly born in the UK. Social (but not private sector) rented sector housing is common. This Supergroup is found throughout the UK's conurbations and industrial regions but is also an integral part of smaller towns.

7a: Established but Challenged

Many households in these neighbourhoods comprise separated or divorced residents, some of whom are single parents with dependent children. Residents are typically born in the UK, and these neighbourhoods have relatively few members of ethnic minorities. The prevalence of children, their parents and those at or above normal retirement age, suggests neighbourhood structures may be long-established. Levels of unpaid care are high, and long-term disability is more common than in the Supergroup as a whole. Use of the social rented sector is common, often in terraced houses. Those in work are employed in elementary occupations such as caring, leisure and customer services. Many residents have low level qualifications. Neighbourhood concentrations of this Group are found in the South Wales Valleys, Belfast, Londonderry and the Central Lowlands of Scotland.

7a1: Ageing Established Urban Communities

These neighbourhoods have higher levels of married couples amongst their predominantly UK-born residents. Neighbourhoods are populated with residents of retirement-age or older affiliated to Christianity. Despite the age structure, provision of unpaid care is less common than the Group average. Residents have frequently received only a rudimentary education and rent their terraced houses in the social rented sector. Unemployment is below the Group average.

7a2: Industry Associations

These neighbourhoods include younger than Group average individuals. Relative to the Group average, more residents are of Mixed or Multiple ethnicities. Many are divorced and reside in socially rented semi detached houses or terraces. Individuals are more likely than the Group average to be educated to A Level/Highers, and to work in managerial occupations. Unemployment rates are lower than the Group average. Many of these neighbourhoods are found close to industrial estates.

7b: Young Families in Industrial Towns

These neighbourhoods house predominantly young, UK-born individuals identifying with a White ethnic group with dependent children. Long-term disability and unpaid care are prevalent, and religious affiliations are uncommon. Housing is terraced or semi-detached and social rented sector housing is the norm. Employment is principally in elementary occupations, as process plant and machine operatives, or in caring and leisure services. Educational attainment is low. The group is scattered throughout former industrial towns in the Midlands and the South Wales Valleys.

7b1 Terraces in Transitional Towns

Levels of marriage are below the Group average but there are higher numbers of dependent children. Adults tend to be younger and most residents are housed at higher densities than elsewhere in the Group. A greater share of adults are EU-born, ethnic diversity is greater, and higher proportions of residents identify as of Mixed or Multiple ethnicities. English is slightly less likely to be the main language used. More individuals do not profess any religion and, amongst those that do, there is lower affiliation to Christian religions. More people are housed in socially rented terraced or semi detached houses which remain the dominant housing type. The employment profile generally mirrors that of the Group, although elementary occupations are each slightly more common.

7b2 – Families and Later Life

Members of this Subgroup are more likely to have been born in the UK and to be part of households with no resident children. Adults are substantially older than those in other Subgroups, with substantial representation of old and very old residents who are above retirement age. Individuals identifying as White are common. Individuals are more likely to live in low-density neighbourhoods of semi-detached houses: some do nevertheless live in terraced houses. There are fewer students, graduates and adults educated to A Level/Higher standard. The employment patterns generally mirror the Group average, albeit with marginally higher rates of employment in administrative and skill trade occupations.

8: Legacy Communities

These neighbourhoods characteristically comprise pockets of flats that are scattered across the UK, particularly in towns that retain or have legacies of heavy industry or are in more remote seaside locations. Employed residents of these neighbourhoods work mainly in low-skilled occupations. Residents typically have limited educational qualifications. Unemployment is above average. Many residents live in the social rented sector and experience long-term disability. All adult age groups are represented, although there is an overall age bias towards elderly people in general and the very old in particular

8a: Routine Occupations or Retirement

These neighbourhoods are characterised by high proportions of single, often never-married adults of normal retirement age or older, including many that are in the most advanced age groups. Most residents are UK born and live at high residential densities. Individuals identifying as members of ethnic minorities are uncommon, but above average proportions of households include individuals that cannot speak English well or at all. Long-term disability is relatively

common, and the dominant accommodation type is flats. Unemployment rates are high, with most of those employed working in routine occupations. Few individuals have high level qualifications. Car ownership is not high.

8a1: Retirement Residences

Many individuals are well beyond normal retirement age, with other age groups being almost absent. Divorced and single-person households are very common, and most residents identify as members of the White ethnic group. Housing and tenure is also highly homogenous, being dominated by flats in the social rented sector. Unemployment is below the Group average and some of those in employment work in managerial or professional occupations.

8a2: Flats and Routine Occupations

These neighbourhoods are mainly comprised of flats, interspersed with occasional semi-detached or terraced houses. There are more families with children, and marriage and civil partnership is less common than in the Group as a whole. Rates of use of English as the main language are slightly lower than Group average and residents are less likely to be affiliated with any religion. There are more students and there is slightly higher unemployment than elsewhere in the Group. Employment is heavily skewed towards the provision of routine services.

8b: Legacy and Demographically Mixed Communities

Households in these areas often include residents who are divorced or separated. The age structure is heavily skewed towards the most advanced age groups. Individuals identifying as members of ethnic minorities are not present in large numbers. Flats predominate, with some terraced, semi-detached, and sparse detached units. Multiple car ownership is low, and housing is predominantly in the private and social rented sectors. Employment is less skewed towards traditional routine industrial occupations. Levels of educational attainment are generally low. The Group occurs principally in the Central Lowlands of Scotland and other Scottish towns.

8b1: Challenged Families

These UK-born families have dependent children, typically in the 5 to 14 age range. Members of this Subgroup are relatively young but lack qualifications from higher education. The very old are much less in evidence. As with the rest of the Group, flats are the most common housing type, although some residents live in terraced houses. Unemployment rates are the highest in the Group, and those in employment primarily hold non-managerial or professional positions.

8b2: Retirement Pockets

Residence in communal establishments is relatively common in these neighbourhoods. Residents are typically of retirement age or older, and live as single person households. More individuals live in detached or semi-detached houses than elsewhere in the Group. There are very few students and little unemployment..

8b3: Young Family Flat Renters

Young families comprising adults aged 25 to 44 are common in these neighbourhoods relative to the Group. Individuals identifying as Indian, Pakistani, Bangladeshi, Chinese or any other Asian background are slightly more common than the Group average. Residents almost exclusively rent in the private sector or own their homes – which are typically flats. Levels of education are higher than elsewhere in the Group, as is the proportion of individuals employed in professional or associate professional occupations. There is a correspondingly lower share of workers in sales and customer service roles.

Update Technical Note

The peer reviewed methodology used to create the 2021 / 22 Output Area Classification is outlined in the following publication:

Wyszomierski, J., Longley, P. A., Singleton, A. D., Gale, C., & O'Brien, O. (2023). A neighbourhood output area classification from the 2021 and 2022 UK censuses. *The Geographical Journal*, 190(2), e12550. <https://doi.org/10.1111/geoj.12550>

As described in this paper, a necessary departure from previous versions of OAC published for the 2011 and 2001 Censuses required accommodation of the phased availability of comparable UK wide small area data between UK nations. The Scottish element of the Census was postponed until 2022, with a knock-on consequence that small area statistics were not published until late 2024, and 2021 small area (Data Zone equivalents of OAs) results for Northern Ireland were published after their counterparts in England and Wales. The 2021/22 OAC was completed as part of a PhD project at University College London with a fixed end date, and so the changed schedule resulted in the preliminary version of OAC being created using the following data and geography:

- England and Wales: 2021 Output Areas and 2021 Census Data
- Northern Ireland: 2011 Small Area boundaries and apportioned 2021 Census Data from Local Government Districts
- Scotland: 2011 Output Areas with modelled 2021 Census Data

The preliminary UK model was created from these data, and the full UK classification was released through the Consumer Data Research Centre (now Geographic Data Service, GeoDS). An England and Wales subset was released through the Office for National Statistics. In late 2024, the final small area data necessary to create an updated UK model were released from National Records of Scotland. In brief, the following update methodology has now been implemented:

- 1) Calculate the cluster mean values for the original preliminary UK model using the original input data (which uses 2021 geography)
- 2) Calculate new OAC input variables for the following geography:
 - a. Scotland: 2022 Output Areas
 - b. Northern Ireland: 2021 Data Zones
- 3) Within Scotland and Northern Ireland only, compare the values of the attributes ascribed to each small area with the preliminary UK model Subgroup cluster means.
 - a. Assign each area into an OAC Subgroup cluster based on its closest match to these values. The following variables were not used in these reassignment

assessments as they were either not available, or were deemed to have incompatible distributions relative to the original input data: v07, v09, v11, v23, v42, v60, v32, v40 and v41.

Each of the 2021 / 22 small areas can be aggregated into the following zonal geography:

- England and Wales: 2021 Output Areas into 2021 Lower layer Super Output Areas (LSOA)
- Scotland: 2022 Output Areas into 2022 Data Zones (DZ)
- Northern Ireland: 2021 Data Zones into 2021 Super Data Zones (SDZ)

The distribution of different OA Subgroup frequency within each LSOA/DZ/SDZ is shown in the following table. As an example of interpretation, 29% of these aggregate areas include 3 different OA level Subgroups.

Subgroup Frequency	Number of LSOA/DZ/SDZ	%
1	1,446	3.3
2	6,350	14.5
3	12,736	29
4	13,267	30.2
5	7,233	16.5
6	2,141	4.9
7	588	1.3
8	129	0.3
9	23	0.1
10	1	0
	43,914	100

For each LSOA/DZ/SDZ aggregation, a single OAC Subgroup was assigned by examining the populations assigned to each underlying OAC Subgroup in its constituent OAs (or Northern Ireland Data Zones). The Subgroup with the largest overall population was then chosen to represent the aggregate zone. The advantage of this method is that it enables a shared taxonomy between the OA and the aggregated zones and does not require a new and unfamiliar classifications to be devised from first principles.